Communication with Impact



Becoming a More Conscious Communicator: A Reflective Journey

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Introduction

Communication extends beyond clarity of speech and not just as a transactional exchange of information but as a strategic capability shaped by mindset, emotional intelligence and the intentional use of influence. Throughout this module, I have realized that while I possess strong analytical abilities and creative thinking, my communication effectiveness depends on how I manage emotional triggers, structure ideas, and engage others with empathy. This report reflects on my growth as a communicator, integrating course theories including Kahneman's System 1 & 2, Goleman's Emotional Intelligence, Dweck's Growth Mindset, Cialdini's persuasion principles and storytelling frameworks, while identifying strategic steps for future development.

Aspirations and goals as a communicator

I aspire to become a communicator who is emotionally mature, able to collaborate with diverse personalities without compromising on my peace and energy. My communication strengths include strong information processing, analytical

depth, creativity and leadership intension which align with Kahneman's System 2 thinking.

In reflection on emotional intelligence, I recognize strong self-awareness and empathy but limited self-regulation, particularly when I feel dismissed. Goleman's Emotional Intelligence model highlights that even if we process situations accurately, ineffective emotional control can reduce impact. I recognize that frustration can lead to reactive responses (System 1) such as interrupting or bluntness, especially when effort or engagement from others is lacking. While this stems from high standards and intrinsic motivation (Pink, 2009), it can unintentionally trigger defensiveness in others.

I see the need to structure my thoughts before presenting to ensure clarity. This aligns with the Pyramid Principle, which advocated communicating from key insight to supporting evidence. Instead of reacting through fast, instinctive System 1 responses, I aim to activate System 2 thinking more intentionally before speaking. My long-term goal is to influence with strategic calmness, integrating emotional intelligence, persuasion and structured communication to become an impactful leader who inspires rather than overwhelms.

I aim to become a communicator who influences strategically rather than intensely, presenting ideas with clarity and emotional awareness. I want to leverage persuasion and

relationship building to bring people on board rather than relying solely on the correctness of my argument.

How course concepts shaped my understanding of communication

The course challenged my assumption that strong logic or solution quality is enough to influence. A key learning occurred during a group assignment where despite proposing a strong idea supported by evidence, including external validation, the team rejected it. I delivered feedback bluntly, believing transparency would drive improvement. Although my analysis was accurate (System 2 driven), the communication style activated defensiveness in others. In hindsight, this scenario demonstrated the importance of combining logic with empathy, emotional pacing and persuasion principles.

Earlier in semester, I proposed a structured team workflow, intending to enhance performance. One team member felt “caged” by the structure, yet later independently adopted a similar approach when leading tasks. This reinforced Ariely’s and Cialdini’s concepts that decisions are often based on emotional ownership rather than logic. Particularly, *liking, consensus and social proof*, helped me understand my

approach prioritized *logical authority* but lacked relational persuasion.

Additionally, another member openly stated she was comfortable receiving a B grade, conflicting with my pursuit of excellence. Later, after I was the only member to rate her slightly lower during peer assessment, she responded passive aggressively. Gradually, my ideas were dismissed regardless of delivery and the group relied on majority voting rather than discussion.

This disengagement affected my motivation, leading to reduced participation. Though my contribution remained high-quality, behavior overshadowed performance. Goleman's framework explains that without emotional control, even strong leadership skills can be perceived negatively. However, in another team I formed for a personal project where I use the same methods, the team aligns and responds positively. This highlights that psychological safety and relational connection significantly impact communication effectiveness. Tresure's principle of speaking with empathy, honesty and intension, emphasizes delivery as much as content.

Dweck's Growth Mindset reframed this experience, rather than viewing resistance as a personal rejection, I now see it as an opportunity to adapt my communication approach. Kahneman's thinking models helped me understand that when emotionally triggered, I revert to reactive behavior instead of engaging analytical reasoning. Moving forward, I am

to pause, acknowledge my emotional response and respond with composure.

Additionally, my body language awareness helped me recognized that while my verbal communication may reflect confidence and critical thinking, my non-verbal cues – such as posture, tone or pace – may unintentionally communicate frustration or urgency. Practicing controlled breathing and mindful body positioning, as suggested by Tressure and public speaking frameworks such as Chris Anderson's TED strategy, can support calm delivery and increase receptiveness to my ideas.

Practical steps to develop my communication

Action	Why	How
• **Use a 2-minute "bullet structure" planning method before speaking in meetings/presentations**	*The Pyramid Principle enables clearer, more strategic communication*	Main point -> 2-3 supporting arguments -> required actions
• **Implement a "*pause, breathe, respond*" strategy to regulate emotional reactions**	*Reduces System 1 reactivity and supports Goleman's self-regulation and System 2 thinking (Kahneman)*	Consciously pause for 3 seconds and take one deep breathe before responding.
• **Use Monoroe's Motivation Sequence when proposing ideas to the group.**	*Helps gain nuy-in instead of challenging resistance.*	Attention->Need -> Solution-> Benefit ->Call to action
• **Practise "reflective listening" before giving feedback or critique**	*Increases empathy (Goleman), improves persuasion (Cialdini's – liking & consensus)*	In conversations, summarise other's viewpoints before offering input.
• **Scheduling weekly 15-minute Growth Mindset review with self-feedback.**	*Supports resilience and reduces personalisation (Dweck)*	Reflective prompts: "What went well?", "What challenged me?" "What did I learn and how can I adapt?"

Conclusion

This reflective journey has highlighted that while I excel in processing information, strategic thinking, and leadership initiative, my communication effectiveness depends on intentional emotional regulation, structure, and influence-based engagement. My goal is to move from intensity to intentionality, aligning cognitive clarity with empathy, using storytelling and persuasion to inspire rather than confront. By integrating structured thinking, emotional intelligence and evidence-based influence strategies. I believe I can develop into a communicator who not only created strong ideas but also mobilises people to act on them.

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